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Editor-in-Chief
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Dear Editor,

I am submitting the manuscript “End-to-End Fidelity Analysis of Quantum Circuit Optimization: From Gate-Level Transformations to Pulse-Level Control” for consideration in *ACM Transactions on Quantum Computing*.

This work presents a framework for analyzing how gate-level circuit optimization decisions propagate through the full quantum compilation stack to affect physical pulse-level fidelity. The key contributions are:

1. **End-to-end fidelity analysis.** We connect a high-performance C++ circuit optimizer with Lindblad-based pulse simulation, evaluating four optimization passes on 371 benchmark circuits across 4,452 experiment runs. Gate cancellation alone accounts for essentially all optimization benefit ($d = 1.53$, large effect), and pulse duration is the strongest predictor of process fidelity ($r = -0.868$, $R^2 = 0.754$).
2. **Compiler comparison methodology.** We show that two-qubit gate counts, not total gate counts, are the appropriate metric for comparing quantum compilers targeting hardware execution. Our optimizer achieves 87.8% two-qubit gate reduction on QFT and 100% on QAOA circuits, while Qiskit’s higher total gate reduction (47.7%) translates to only 9.3% two-qubit gate reduction due to virtual basis gate consolidation.
3. **Formal ablation study.** Individual pass, leave-one-out, and ordering analyses with statistical significance testing (Kruskal-Wallis, Cohen’s d , Wilcoxon) provide rigorous quantification of each optimization pass’s contribution.
4. **Hardware validation.** We validate simulation predictions on the IQM Resonance Garnet 20-qubit superconducting processor, achieving 70% gate reduction on QFT circuits with 100% job success rate.
5. **Reproducibility.** All software, data, and analysis scripts are open-source at <https://github.com/rylanmalarchick/qco-integration> and <https://github.com/rylanmalarchick/quantum-circuit-optimizer>.

This work is well-suited for ACM TQC because it addresses a gap at the intersection of quantum compilation and quantum hardware characterization. The emphasis on rigorous statistical methodology, fair comparison metrics, and hardware validation aligns with the journal’s standards.

An earlier version of this work appeared as arXiv:2601.20871. The current submission has been substantially revised with real C++ optimizer and Lindblad pulse simulation data (replacing the

simplified mock pipeline used in the simulation campaign), an expanded compiler comparison, a formal ablation study, and a comprehensive bibliography. The hardware validation on IQM Resonance reported in the preprint is retained.

This manuscript has not been submitted elsewhere and is not under consideration at any other journal. The author declares no conflicts of interest.

Sincerely,

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